

Facebook

Read [README.md](#) first — it has the link format and the link test that this guide assumes you have done.

What works today: a Facebook post or ad carries the property link, the person lands on the client's website, and the enquiry reaches the CRM.

What does not: Facebook Instant Forms. A form that opens inside Facebook keeps its leads inside Meta. Nothing arrives in the CRM or the client's inbox.

1. Accounts

The client owns everything. A developer or agency gets access, never ownership — otherwise the client loses their Page and ad history when the relationship ends.

The Page

Sign in as the client and open <https://www.facebook.com/pages/create>.

Enter the Page name, category, and description.

Add the logo, cover image, public phone number and email, the office address or service area, and the website address.

Publish it and check that the business name and contact details match what the property page says.

The business portfolio and ad account

Open [Meta Business Suite](#) and create a business portfolio in the client's legal business name.

In **Settings**, confirm the portfolio owns both the Page and the ad account. If either already exists elsewhere, request access to it rather than moving ownership casually — transfers are hard to reverse.

Add each staff member with their own Facebook login and only the access they need. Never share one password between people.

Turn on two-factor authentication for everyone with admin access, and record two people who can recover the account.

In Ads Manager, finish the ad account setup and add the payment method.

2. Publish a post

Switch into the Page: select your profile picture, then **See all profiles**, then the Page.

Select the post box at the top of the Page feed.

Paste the property link and wait for the preview card to load.

Write the caption. It must agree with the property page on price, availability, location, and who is selling. Include the registration details the page shows.

Add your own or licensed images. Do not use stock photos of a different building.

Post it, then open the post as a visitor and click through to check the link.

For scheduled or draft posts, use **Create post** in Meta Business Suite instead. Same content rules.

Do not cross-post a link containing `utm_source=facebook` to Instagram. Instagram traffic would then be counted as Facebook. Use the Instagram guide and its own link.

3. Run an ad

Use Ads Manager rather than the **Boost post** button. Boost hides the settings that matter here — placement control and the destination URL.

Since February 2026, Meta has one campaign creation flow. Its AI features (Advantage+) are switched on by default for audience, placements, and budget, and each can be switched off individually. There is no longer a separate "manual" campaign type to choose.

Campaign

In Ads Manager, select + **Create**.

Objective: **Traffic**. This optimises for link clicks and does not require a pixel. Do not choose **Leads** — see section 5.

Name the campaign with the same campaign key that is in the link.

Special Ad Category: if your account offers **Housing**, select it. It is required for housing ads in a growing list of countries and running without it is a common cause of account restrictions. It removes some targeting options by design; do not skip the declaration to get them back.

Set the budget and either an end date or a named person responsible for stopping it.

Ad set

Name it with the market and placement.

Destination: **Website**.

Performance goal: **maximise number of link clicks**. Anything that optimises for conversions needs a pixel, which is not installed.

Set the schedule and the locations you are allowed to target. Housing ads restrict location targeting to a minimum radius in some markets, and postcode targeting may be unavailable.

Placements: turn off Advantage+ placements and select Facebook placements only — Facebook Feed is enough for a first campaign. Deselecting any placement turns Advantage+ placements off; you should see it marked as off. Exclude Instagram, Messenger, Threads, and Audience Network. They need their own link and their own review.

Ad

Identity: the client's Facebook Page.

Choose **Create ad** for new creative, or **Use existing post** if you are promoting a post you have already checked.

Add the images or video, primary text, headline, and description.

Website URL: paste the complete link, parameters included.

If Ads Manager offers to append URL parameters, leave it empty. Your link already has them, and duplicates break attribution.

Do not attach a pixel, an instant form, a call button, or a WhatsApp or Messenger destination.

Open **Ad preview**, click the button, and confirm it lands on the property page with all four `utm_` values still present. Meta may add `fbclid` — that is expected and the CRM handles it.

Publish.

Meta reviews ads automatically. Campaign, ad set, and ad each have their own status; check all three in the **Delivery** column.

4. After launch

Start with a small budget and run the link test from the live ad preview on both an iPhone and an Android phone, including Facebook's in-app browser. That browser is where destination problems usually appear first.

Then confirm one test enquiry arrives with source `facebook` and the expected campaign key, and that the email reached every recipient.

5. Two things to leave alone for now

The Leads objective. Meta offers it with three conversion locations:

Instant Forms, Website, and — in some accounts — **Website and Instant Forms**. The Website option does send people to your page, but its optimisation depends on the Meta Pixel reporting conversions back. Without the pixel it has no advantage over Traffic, and the Instant Form options do not reach the CRM at all.

The Meta Pixel and Conversions API. Neither is installed, by decision. They measure ad performance; they do not deliver leads. Adding either means a privacy review, a consent mechanism, and code that fires only after the CRM has durably saved an enquiry. Do not install a pixel just because Ads Manager asks for one.

6. Problems

What you see	Cause	Fix
The Page is missing from Identity	The ad account and Page are not in the same business portfolio, or you lack access	Fix the access. Do not substitute a different Page
Ad rejected	Open the ad and read the policy reason	Fix the actual issue. Housing ads are usually rejected for a missing category declaration or a targeting restriction
Instagram is getting the Facebook link	A placement or cross-post setting is on	Pause, split the platforms, use the Instagram link
CRM source shows unknown	<code>utm_source</code> is misspelled	It must be exactly <code>facebook</code> , lowercase
"Property unavailable"	Wrong slug, or the property is not active	Fix the property record. A link cannot override it
Form succeeded, no email	Normal — the enquiry is saved and the email is queued	Check the outbox as described in ../README.md
Instant Form leads are not in the CRM	That path does not exist	Pause the campaign. Export the leads from Ads Manager manually

Sources

[Traffic objective](#) — confirmed 7 August 2026: optimises for link clicks, landing page views, or daily unique reach

[Create a Facebook Page for your business](#)

[How to choose a Special Ad Category](#)

[Lead ads with forms](#)

Meta's Help Centre pages load their content with JavaScript and could not be read by an automated check, so exact button labels here come from current practitioner documentation of the February 2026 unified campaign flow rather than from a Meta page quote. The structure — campaign, ad set, ad; Traffic; Special Ad Category; placement control — is stable. Confirm the wording in your account.